



Pixel updates till 2018

Google has declared that Pixel phones will receive guaranteed updates for 2 yrs at least <http://dgit.in/PixelUpd2018>



Of ad agreements

Snapchat might move from ad revenue sharing to licensing fees <http://dgit.in/SnapAdAgr>

Dual Camera Phones



PARAMETER #1: COLOUR ACCURACY AND WHITE BALANCE

Apple iPhone 7 Plus

The Apple iPhone 7 Plus retains the signature characteristic of iPhones, shooting photographs with accurate colours and white balance. The iPhone 7 Plus uses two different sensors with the same megapixel count - a 1/3"-type 12MP sensor behind the 28mm, f/1.8 lens, and a 1/3.6"-type 12MP sensor behind the 56mm, f/2.8 lens. These sensors are comparatively smaller than the sensors used on other flagships this year (1/2.6" on LG G5, 1/2.3" on Google Pixel XL), and although that theoretic-



cally translates to lesser details and more noise, Apple has once again aced its algorithms.

As a result, the level of brightness is well-maintained in photographs, although in telephoto, the smaller sensor and an f/2.8 lens makes the iPhone 7 Plus shoot inherently darker photos, when you zoom in. It tries to make up by drawing light and contrast data from the other sensor, but other cameras do shoot brighter pics.

In terms of white balance, the iPhone 7 Plus keeps it as close to the ambient colour temperature as possible, leading to pleasantly warm tones under bright autumn daylight, and neutral tones during dusk, allowing room for post-processing of photographs.

Huawei P9

The Huawei P9, in an attempt to make photographs appear vibrant, oversaturates colours. As a result, the intensity of colour tones look a bit too high. Objects with sharp colours do look vibrant, but the vibrancy comes in exchange for true-to-source colours.

However, the Huawei P9 natively shoots much deeper blacks, and is great and rendering bright frames, all of which contribute to sharp, vibrant and lively photographs. It is not the result that would please photographers (that



honour belongs to the iPhone), but for shooting instant moments, the Huawei P9 is actually quite ideal.

When it comes to white balance, the Huawei P9 tends to favour cooler colour temperatures. This makes auto shooting under bright daylight a tricky affair, but its 'Pro' mode is a good way to tweak the white balance. The higher saturation levels also contribute in drawing such sharp colours. However, it needs to be noted that with the level of sharpness that the Huawei P9's Leica-branded cameras produce, photographs do not entirely look bad. Colours do appear slightly unnatural, and the overall white balance makes photographs look edited, but many may like the overall look of photographs here.

Honor 8

The Honor 8 uses the same Sony IMX286 image sensors, one to capture colour data and the other to shoot the same image in monochrome. The mechanism also remains the same, except for the Leica certification. It is interesting to note, though, that the Honor 8 produces lesser oversaturation in its photos, and is much closer to the colours of the image source than the Huawei P9. The level of contrast, however, is notably lower in photographs shot by Honor 8. With the oversatura-



tion and lower contrasts combined, colours in photographs shot by the Honor 8 look somewhat off the mark.

The Honor 8 does a decent job of handling white balance, and photographs bear colour tones close to the original ambience. Noticeably, the Honor 8 renders most photographs with a slight warm tone, which does make photographs look pleasant. The added warm tone makes overcast conditions look more intense in photographs, and shooting in diffused sunlight leaves photographs with a deeper amber tone. As opposed to the overall flatter colour tone produced by the Huawei P9, the Honor 8 distinctly favours warmer tones, slightly oversaturated colours and lower contrast.